

Diabetes Medicines - NIDDK

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Insulin, Medicines, & Other Diabetes Treatments - NIDDK Home Health Information Diabetes Diabetes Overview Insulin, Medicines, & Other Diabetes Treatments Related Topics English English Espa#241;ol Insulin, Medicines, & Other Diabetes Treatments On this page: What medicines might I take for diabetes? What type of diabetes do I have? What are the different types of insulin? What are the different ways to take insulin? What oral medicines treat type 2 diabetes? What other injectable medicines treat diabetes? What should I know about side effects of diabetes medicines? What questions should I ask about my diabetes medicines? Do I have other treatment options for my diabetes? Clinical Trials for Insulin, Medicines, & Other Diabetes Treatments Taking insulin or other diabetes medicines is often part of treating diabetes. In addition to making healthy food and beverage choices, getting physical activity, getting enough sleep, and managing stress, medicines can help you manage the disease. Some other treatment options are also available. What medicines might I take for diabetes? The medicine you take depends on the type of diabetes you have and how well the medicine controls your blood glucose levels, also called blood sugar levels. Other factors, such as any other health conditions you may have, medication costs, your insurance coverage and copays, access to care, and your lifestyle, may affect what diabetes medicine you take. What type of diabetes do I have? Type 1 diabetes If you have type 1 diabetes , you must take insulin because your pancreas does not make it. You will need to take insulin several times dur

Do I have other treatment options for my diabetes? If medicines and lifestyle changes are not enough to manage your diabetes, there are other treatments that might help you. These treatments include weight-loss (bariatric) surgery for certain people with type 1 or type 2 diabetes, or pancreatic islet transplantation for some people with type 1 diabetes. Weight-loss surgery Weight-loss surgery are operations that help you lose weight by making changes to your digestive system. Weight-loss surgery is also called bariatric or metabolic surgery. This type of surgery may help some people who have obesity and type 2 diabetes lose a large amount of weight and bring their blood glucose levels back to a healthy range. How long the improved response lasts can vary by patient, type of weight-loss surgery, and the amount of weight the person lost. Other factors include how long a person had diabetes and whether the person used insulin. Some people with type 2 diabetes may no longer need to use diabetes medicines after weight-loss surgery . 4 Researchers are studying whether weight-loss surgery can help control blood glucose levels in people with type 1 diabetes who have obesity. 5 Pancreatic islet transplantation Pancreatic islet transplantation is a treatment for type 1 diabetes in people who struggle to manage their blood glucose levels. Pancreatic islets are clusters of cells in the pancreas that make the hormone insulin. In type 1 diabetes, the body's immune system attacks these cells. A pancreatic islet transplantation replaces destroyed islets with new islets from a deceased donor. The new islets make and release insulin. Clinical Trials for Insulin, Medicines, & Other Diabetes Treatments The NIDDK conducts and supports clinical trials in many diseases and conditions, including diabetes. The trials look to find new ways to prevent, detect, or treat disease and improve quality of life. What are clinical trials for insulin, medicines, and other diabe